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County: los-angeles

Division: Civil Law and Motion

Department: O

Hearing date: 2026-06-30

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Case Number: 24VECV04613 Hearing Date: June 30, 2026 Dept: O

SUPERIOR COURT OF THE STATE OF CALIFORNIA

COUNTY OF LOS ANGELES - NORTHWEST DISTRICT

TAIYON ELIJAH HECTOR, an Individual,

Plaintiff,

vs.

ANGELA

RENEE WHITE a.k.a. BLAC CHYNA, an Individual, and Does 1-10, inclusive.

Defendant.

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CASE NO.: 24VECV04613

ORDER

GRANTING CROSS-DEFENDANT'S MOTION TO STRIKE PORTIONS OF CROSS-COMPLAINT
PURSUANT TO CODE OF CIVIL PROCEDURE § 425.16 (ANTI-SLAPP)

ANGELA

RENEE WHITE a.k.a. BLAC CHYNA, an Individual,

Cross-Complainant,

vs.

TAIYON

ELIJAH HECTOR, aka TAIYON "TWIN" HECTOR, aka TWIN HECTOR, aka TEAM TWIN, aka
TEAM HECTOR, aka LIL TWIN, an individual, and ROES 1-20, inclusive,

Cross-Defendants.

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I.

BACKGROUND

Plaintiff Taiyon Elijah

Hector ("Hector") filed this personal injury action against Angela Renee White a.k.a. Blac Chyna ("White"). Hector alleges he lived with White when she would become physically violent and verbally abusive towards him, including while he was asleep, causing him injury. (See Compl., ¶¶ 20, 30.)

White filed a

Cross-Complaint alleging that following the termination of her romantic relationship with Hector, he has continued an escalating campaign of

harassment, defamation, and commercial exploitation of White's identity. (See Cross-Compl., ¶ 10.)

Hector moves to strike portions of the Cross-Complaint under the anti-SLAPP statute.

II.

PROCEDURAL

HISTORY

On September 24, 2024, Hector filed a Complaint alleging (1) Violation of California Domestic Violence Prevention Act – Civil Code §1708.6; (2) Civil Assault; (3) Civil Battery; (4) Intentional Infliction of Emotional Distress; (5) Negligent Infliction of Emotional Distress; and (6) Negligence – Premises Liability.

On July 1, 2025, the Court entered default against White.

On December 30, 2025, the Court granted White's Motion to Set Aside and Motion to Quash and denied her Motion to Seal.

On February 4, 2026, the Court denied White's Motion to Seal.

On March 27, 2026, White filed a Cross-Complaint alleging (1) Breach of Contract (Non-Disclosure Agreement); (2) Defamation (Libel and Slander); (3) Intentional Infliction of Emotional Distress; (4) Assault; (5) Battery; (6) Conversion; (7) Fraud and Intentional Misrepresentation; (8) Misappropriation of Name, Image, and Likeness / Right of Publicity; (9) Civil Stalking (California Civil Code § 1708.7); (10) Unfair Competition (California Business & Professions Code § 17200 et seq.); (11) False Light Invasion of Privacy; (12) Public Disclosure of Private Facts; (13) Negligent Infliction of Emotional Distress (In the Alternative); and (14) Violation of California Civil Code § 1708.6.

On May 26, 2026, Hector filed the instant Anti-SLAPP Motion.

On May 27, 2026, White filed
an Answer.

As of June 25, 2026, no
opposition has been filed.

III.

LEGAL STANDARD

“A cause of action against a person arising
from any act of that person in furtherance of the person’s right of petition or
free speech under the United States Constitution or the California Constitution
in connection with a public issue shall be subject to a special motion to
strike, unless the court determines that the plaintiff has established that
there is a probability that the plaintiff will prevail on the
claim.” (Code Civ. Proc. § 425.16 (b)(1).)[1]

“A court
evaluates an anti-SLAPP motion in two steps. ‘Initially, the moving defendant
bears the burden of establishing that the challenged allegations or
claims ‘arise from’ protected activity in which the defendant has engaged. If
the defendant carries its burden, the plaintiff must
then demonstrate its claims have at least ‘minimal
merit.’ [Citation.] If the plaintiff fails to meet that
burden, the court will strike the claim.” (Wilson v. Cable News
Network, Inc. (2019) 7 Cal.5th 871, 884.) 2

IV.

ANALYSIS

Hector moves
to strike the following causes of action (the “Challenged Claims”) from White’s
Cross-Complaint: (1) Second Cause of Action for Defamation (Libel and Slander);
(2) Third Cause of Action for Intentional Infliction of Emotional Distress; (3)
Eleventh Cause of Action for False Light Invasion of Privacy; (4) Twelfth Cause
of Action for Public Disclosure of Private Facts; and (5) Thirteenth Cause of
Action for Negligent Infliction of Emotional Distress.

A.

First Prong – Hector Meets his Burden

to Show Protected Activity

Hector

contends the Challenged Claims are based wholly or in part on his appearance at a January 13, 2024, interview on the YouTube channel unWineWithTashaK (“Interview”) (see Cross-Compl., ¶ 23), his December 13, 2025, album release (“Album”) (see id., ¶¶ 25-51), and his December 15, 2025, Instagram posts (“Instagram posts”) (see id., ¶ 26). (See Mot. at 6:16-7:11.) Hector argues these collective communications are protected under § 425.16(e)(3) and (e)(4). (See Mot. at 4:15-17.) Hector argues the Interview, Album, and Instagram posts were all made in a public forum under § 425.16(e)(3). (See id., at 4:23-27, 5:4-7, citing *Lieberman v. KCOP Television, Inc.* (2003) 110Cal.App.4th 156, 164; *Chaker v. Mateo* (2012) 209 Cal.App.4th 1138, 1146 [internet posts are public forums], and *Grenier v. Taylor* (2015) 234 Cal.App.4th 471, 484.) Hector also argues the Album’s artwork and promotional materials are clearly integral to the artistic work of the Album and are likewise protected. (See id., at 5:4-7.)

Hector

attests the YouTube channel unWineWithTashaK is publicly accessible celebrity entertainment channel with a large audience. (See Declaration Taiyon Elijah Hector filed May 26, 2026 (“Hector Decl.”), ¶ 4.) Hector attests his Instagram posts were posted to his public account and his Album, *I Hate you 2*, was released publicly through standard music distribution channels. (See id., ¶¶ 5-6.)

Hector argues

his speech and artistic works published in the Interview, Album, and Instagram posts concern matters of public interest, namely White’s character as Hector perceived it during their relationship and their breakup. (See Mot. at 5:2-3, 20-22; see also Hector Decl., ¶ 6.) Hector contends he and White are public figures; White is a “public figure, entertainer, ... business owner”, and “media personality” and Hector is “a rapper, musician, and media personality.” (Cross-Compl., ¶¶ 1, 6-7.) Accordingly, Hector argues his Interview, Album, and Instagram posts are protected under § 425.16(e)(3) and (e)(4).

The Court

finds Hector makes a prima facie showing White’s Challenged Claims arise in part from Hector’s protected speech. The anti-SLAPP statute protects statements and writings “made in a place open to the public or a public forum in

connection with an issue of public interest.” (Code Civ. Proc. § 425.16(e)(3).)

The statute also protects “any other conduct in furtherance of the exercise of the constitutional right of petition or the constitutional right of free speech in connection with a public issue or an issue of public interest” (See *id.*, § 425.16(e)(4).) Section 425.16(e)(4) has no public forum requirement. (See *id.*; see also *Hailstone v. Martinez* (2008) 169 Cal.App.4th 728, 736.)

The facts

here trigger protection under both categories. The Court first turns to whether Hector’s statements were made in a public forum and then whether the statements concern matters of public interest.

As to the

first, the Court finds Hector’s published his statements on a public forum. A website open to the public is a “public forum” or a place “open to the public” within the meaning of section 425.16. (See *Barrett v. Rosenthal* (2006) 40 Cal.4th 33, 41.) Here, the Interview was published on the publicly accessible YouTube channel *unWineWithTashaK* and Hector’s Instagram posts were published on his public Instagram account. YouTube and Instagram are two social media platforms accessible online and are thus public forums.

The Court

does not find the Album is a public forum such that it qualifies as protected activity under § 425.16(e)(3). “A public forum is a place open to the use of the general public for purposes of assembly, communicating thoughts between citizens, and discussing public questions.” (*Kurwa v. Harrington, Foxx, Dubrow & Canter, LLP* (2007) 146 Cal.App.4th 841, 846 [internal quotes omitted].)

The Court does not find a music album is a setting or context open to use by the general public. The cases Hector cites, *Lieberman* and *Grenier*, do not hold music albums are public forums under § 425.16(e)(3).[2] However, the Album need not qualify as a public forum to constitute protected activity under § 425.16(e)(4), it need only concern matters of public interest. The Court next turns whether the statements made in the Interview, Instagram posts, and Album concern matters of public interest.

The Court

finds the collective publications at issue concern matters of public interest. An issue of public interest within the meaning of the anti-SLAPP statute is “any issue in which the public is interested.” (*Nygård, Inc. v. Uusi-Kerttula* (2008) 159 Cal.App.4th 1027, 1042.) An issue may be of “public interest” without being

of public importance or significance. (See *id.* [former employee's statements to magazine about his work experience for prominent businessman and celebrity were of "public interest"]; but see *Albanese v. Menounos* (2013) 218 Cal.App.4th 923, 935-936 [rejecting interpretation of *Nygård* as holding any statement about a person in the public eye is matter of public interest].)

"The most commonly articulated definitions of 'statements made in connection with a public issue' focus on whether (1) the subject of the statement or activity precipitating the claim was a person or entity in the public eye; (2) the statement or activity precipitating the claim involved conduct that could affect large numbers of people beyond the direct participants; and (3) whether the statement or activity precipitating the claim involved a topic of widespread public interest. [Citations.]" (See *Wilbanks v. Wolk* (2004) 121 Cal.App.4th 883, 898.)

To determine whether a particular statement is protected as being in connection with an issue of public interest, a two-part test is used. First, the court must decide what "issue of public interest the speech in question implicates—a question we answer by looking to the content of the speech." Second, the court examines the "functional relationship ... between the speech and the public conversation about some matter of public interest." (*FilmOn.com Inc. v. DoubleVerify Inc.* (2019) 7 Cal.5th at 149-150 [internal quotes omitted].) This second part of the test includes determining if the speaker "participated in, or furthered, the discourse that makes an issue one of public interest." (*Id.*, 7 Cal.5th at 246; see also *Wilbanks v. Wolk* (2004) 121 Cal.App.4th 883, 898 [a statement or activity precipitating the claim involved a topic of widespread public interest must in some manner itself contribute to the public debate.]).

The Court finds Hector's Interview statements concerning his relationship with White furthered the discourse on matters of public interest. Here, the Complaint alleges Hector made statements in the Interview that: (1) White was physically and verbally abusive throughout their relationship and she became violent when using alcohol or drugs and would not remember incidents the next day; (2) White attempted to strangle him and used objects as weapons including phone cords, kitchen utensils, and furniture to threaten him; (3) White attacked him while he was asleep causing him bodily injury; (4) White's physician made private

house calls to their home rather than have him go to a hospital, as if to conceal the incidents; (5) White threatened to kill him during arguments and while he was sleeping; and (6) Private and confidential details about Cross-Complainant's family, including her mother, Tokyo Toni (Shalana Jones-Hunter), including characterizations of her conduct and alleged private communications.

Here, the

Cross-Complaint alleges the Interview was published on the "YouTube channel unWineWithTashaK, hosted by Tasha K (Latasha Transrina Kebe), a celebrity entertainment platform with an estimated 1.3 million subscribers..."

(Cross-Compl., ¶ 23.) The alleged statements Hector made concern White, a media personality professionally known as Blac Chyna who "first gained prominence in the early 2010s through modeling and hip-hop culture, and later achieved mainstream recognition through reality television, including the E! series *Rob & Chyna*." (Id., ¶¶ 1, 6.) White "has publicly engaged in significant personal growth, including rebranding under her given name, Angela White, and actively promoting a sobriety and wellness journey that has become a central and commercially essential element of her professional identity and brand relationships." (Id.) Celebrities are generally considered to be people in the "public eye" whose activities are a "topic of widespread public interest." (*Hilton v. Hallmark Cards* (9th Cir. 2010) 599 F.3d 894, 907.) The Court finds Hector's statements concerning White's behavior during their relationship implicate White's character, an issue of public interest given she maintains some level of celebrity status. The Court finds Hector's Interview statements published on a YouTube channel that delivers entertainment news to many viewers likely encouraged the public to discuss White's character and whether her public presentation is a façade. Accordingly, Hector's Interview statements concerning White's behavior during her relationship with Hector concern matters of public concern. Hector has shown his statements during the Interview are protected activity under § 425.16(e)(3).

The Court also finds Hector's statements in his Instagram posts and Album furthered the discourse on matters of public interest. The Cross-Complaint alleges Hector published Instagram posts containing "profane and derogatory statements targeting [White] on Instagram and published [White's] photograph or likeness without her prior consent..." (Cross-Compl., ¶ 26.) The Instagram posts disclosed that White's physician made private house calls to treat alleged injuries at their home rather than a hospital; White's personal substance use during the

relationship; White's relationship conduct, alleged personal behaviors, and private communications; and information about White's family including her mother. (See *id.*, ¶ 146.) The Cross-Complaint alleges Hector released an Album containing song lyrics disclosing the same content as his Instagram posts and cover depicting White's photograph. (See Cross-Compl., ¶¶ 25, 51, 76c, 147.) The Cross-Complaint also alleged the Album's promotional materials contained statements directed at White. (See *id.*, ¶ 51.)[3] The Court finds Hector's Instagram posts and Album depicting White's likeness and concerning White's behavior during their relationship concern matters of public interest for the same reason the Court finds his Interview statements do, as all three publications contain the same content. Accordingly, Hector has shown his Instagram posts are protected under § 425.16(e)(3) and his Album is protected activity under § 425.16(e)(4).

The Court also finds the Challenged Claims arise from Hector's statements in the Interview, Instagram posts, and Album. The second cause of action for defamation arises from the Album, including its cover, and Instagram posts. (See Cross-Compl., ¶ 84, 89.) The third cause of action for IIED, eleventh cause of action for false light, twelfth cause of action for public disclosure, and thirteenth cause of action for NIED arise wholly or in part from the Interview, Album, and Instagram posts. (See *id.*, ¶¶ 93, 141, 146-147, 152.) Thus, the Challenged Claims arise from protected activity and the burden shifts to White to show probability of success on the merits.

White fails to make a *prima facie* showing the Challenged Claims have merit as no opposition was filed.

Accordingly, the Court GRANTS Hector's Special Motion to Strike.

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V.

CONCLUSION

Based on the foregoing, the Court GRANTS Hector's Special Motion to Strike pursuant to Code of Civil Procedure § 425.16(c).

Hector will
be entitled to attorney fees pursuant to a noticed motion.

IT
IS SO ORDERED.

DATED: June 30, 2026

Hon. Michael R. Amerian

Judge,
Superior Court

[1] All statutory references
are to California codes unless stated otherwise.

[2] Lieberman holds broadcast media was an act in furtherance of the appellant's exercise of a constitutional right to free speech in connection with a public issue. (See Lieberman, 110 Cal.App.4th at 165.) Grenier holds statements made on a Web site are made in a public forum. (See Grenier v. Taylor (2015) 234 Cal.App.4th 471, 481.)

[3] The Cross-Complaint does not allege the specific statements contained in the Album's promotional materials. Taking the allegations at paragraphs 51 and 146-147 together, the Court infers the promotional materials also contain the same statements as the Instagram posts and Interview. The Court's findings thus apply to the Album's promotional materials to the extent they include the same statements as alleged in paragraph 146, as these statements would be related to the Album's alleged subject matter, White. (See Code Civ. Proc. § 425.17(d)(2) [An anti-SLAPP motion can be used to strike lawsuits against a person or entity based on "the creation, dissemination, exhibition, advertisement, or other similar promotion of any dramatic, literary, musical, political, or artistic work"].)